



BUILDING YOUR DATA PORTFOLIO

WHY DO YOU NEED A PORTFOLIO?

PROVE THAT YOU HAVE THE **SKILLS FOR THE JOB**

Resumes and LinkedIn profiles can help TELL employers about your skills, but project portfolios allow to actually **SHOW them what you are capable of**

A great project portfolio should highlight:

- ✓ Technical proficiency
- ✓ Strategic thinking
- ✓ Communication skills
- ✓ Business acumen
- ✓ Passion for analytics

Analytics Trifecta! 👍



HOW TO FIND PROJECTS

Don't have any professional analytics experience or projects to showcase? There are a number of ways to **find projects for your portfolio**

COURSE PROJECTS

Most courses at Maven Analytics (*and other platforms*) are **hands-on & project-based**.

Use existing course projects or create your own using the provided data to start building a portfolio while you learn.

PUBLIC DATA

Explore free datasets and recommended analyses in our **Data Playground**.

Other sources to check out:

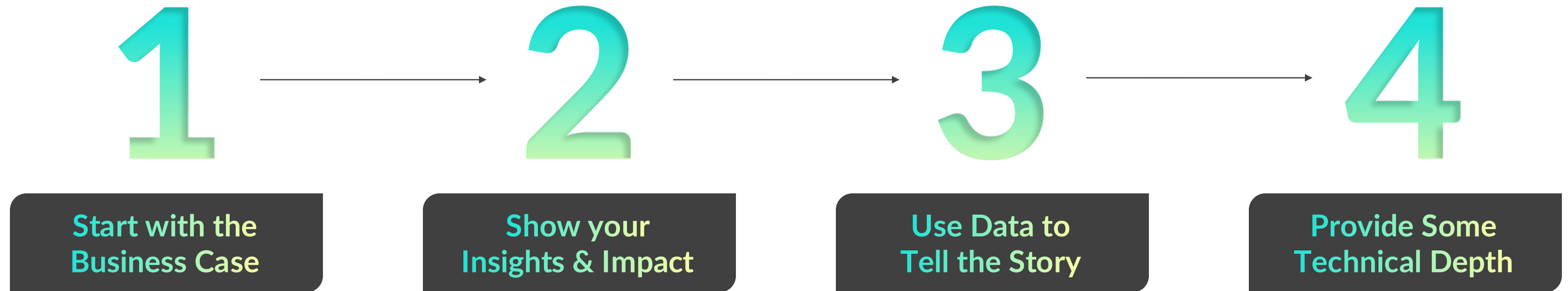
- **Kaggle**
- **Data.World**
- **Data.Gov**
- **EarthData.Nasa.Gov**
- **World Health Organization**

VOLUNTEER PROJECTS

One of the best ways to get tangible, real-world experience without a job is **volunteering**.

Offer to help a small business or non-profit with an analytics project to build your portfolio and get practical experience at the same time – win-win!

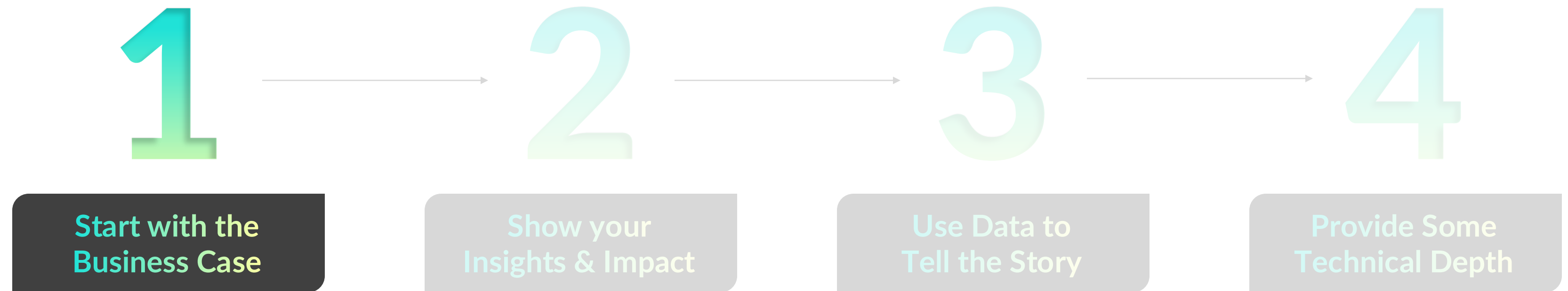
ELEMENTS OF A WINNING PROJECT



A great portfolio project should be **clear and easily consumable**, and guide the viewer through your thought process and approach:

1. What's the **business case or context** behind the project?
2. What **key insights** were you able to derive, and what **impact** did they have on the business?
3. How are you using **data and visualization** to tell the story or support your findings?
4. What **technical tools or techniques** did you use to conduct the analysis?

STEP 1: THE BUSINESS CASE



You may lose your audience if you dive straight into the technical stuff, so lead with high-level context, including a **description of the business case** and the **problem you solved**

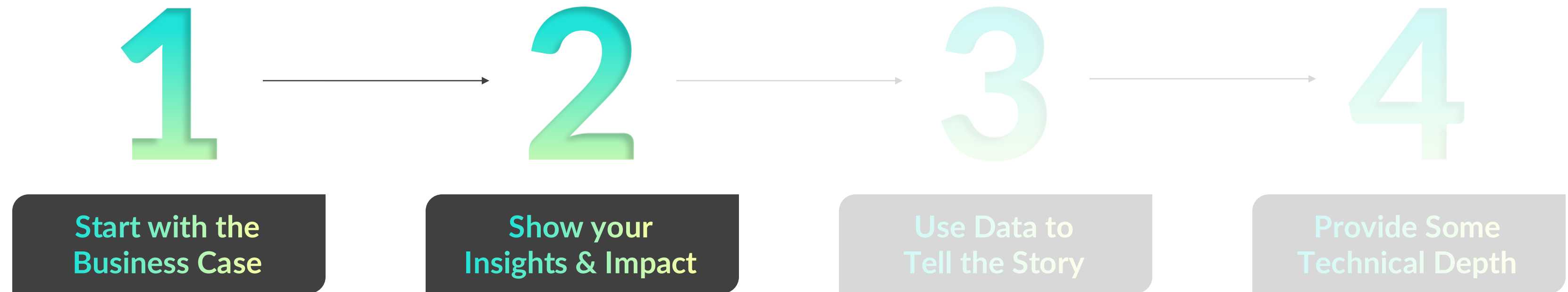
Examples:

- *Hotel cancellations cost the business nearly \$1 million in revenue last year*
- *Marketing campaign conversion rates have dropped steadily this year*
- *Growth in website visits has not translated into increased conversions*



PRO TIP: Lead with business context to speak the language of potential employers and keep non-technical audiences engaged

STEP 2: INSIGHTS & IMPACT



Now that the audience is aware of the context, describe the **key insights you derived** in your analysis and the **impact they drove for the business**

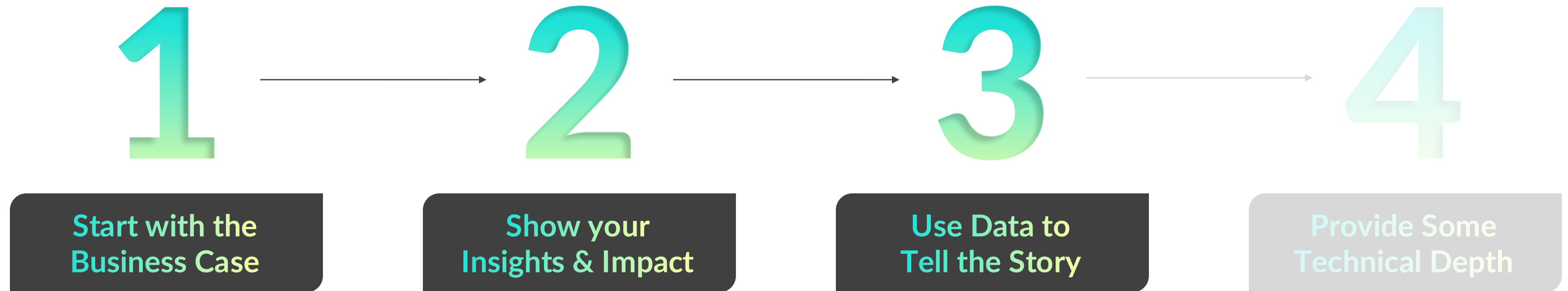
Examples:

- *I proposed a strategy to reduce cancellation risk while increasing revenue*
- *I optimized paid search ad campaigns and grew customer acquisition by 50%*
- *I analyzed website performance to identify drop-off in the conversion funnel*



PRO TIP: Include tangible, measurable results whenever possible to quantify the impact of your analysis

STEP 3: DATA STORYTELLING



The next step is to take it a level deeper and use **data-driven storytelling** to bring your analysis to life

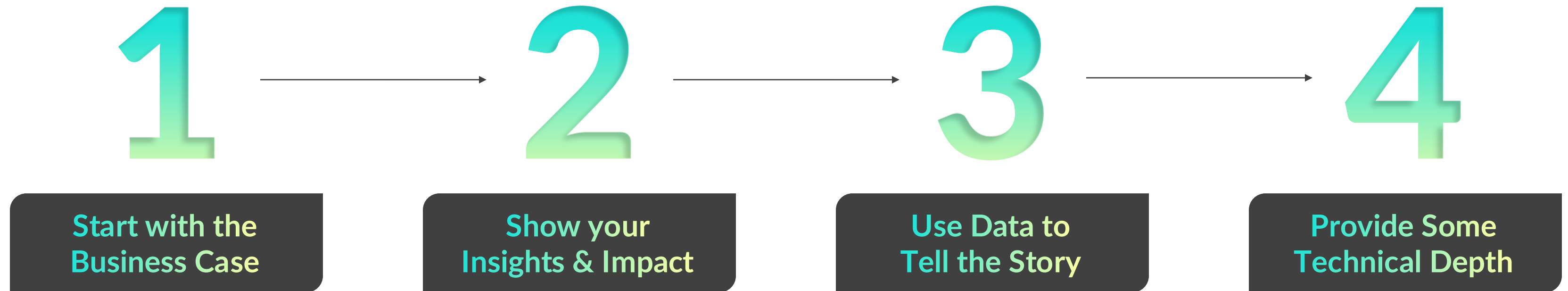
DO THIS

- ✓ Use data visualization whenever possible (*vs. raw code or tables*)
- ✓ Focus on data that directly supports the business case and outcome
- ✓ Showcase your written and visual communication skills, and focus on telling a clear and logical story

DON'T DO THIS

- ✗ Go deep in the technical weeds...yet
- ✗ Try to include EVERYTHING (*this will distract from your best points*)
- ✗ Write poorly or make careless spelling or grammatical errors

STEP 4: TECHNICAL DEPTH



Portfolio projects should be designed to appeal to a broad audience, but often include links or deep dives specifically tailored to those **looking for more technical depth**

Examples:

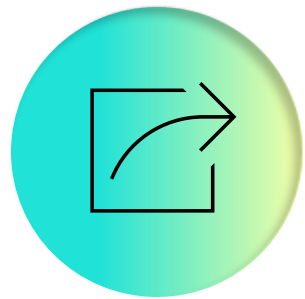
- Downloadable workbooks or project files
- Code samples or GitHub links
- Public Power BI or Tableau dashboards
- Blog posts, technical tutorials, or video walkthroughs



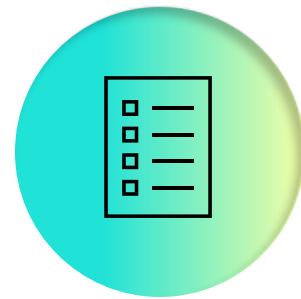
PRO TIP: The key is to make details available to those who want it (*like a fellow analyst*), without overwhelming those who don't (*like a recruiter or hiring manager*)

PACKAGING A PROJECT PORTFOLIO

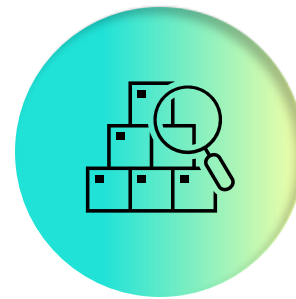
There are a number of options for **building and managing project portfolios**, but ideally you should look for a solution that meets the following criteria:



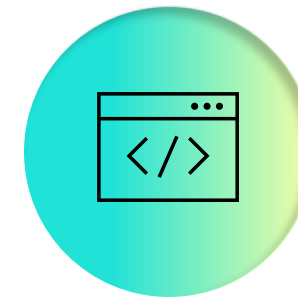
**Easily
sharable**



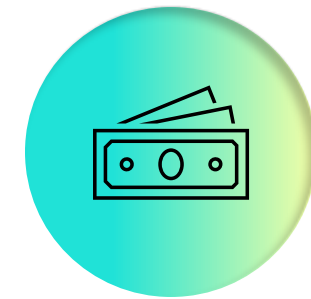
**Clear &
consumable**



**Publicly
accessible**



**Easy to
manage**



**Free/cheap
to host**

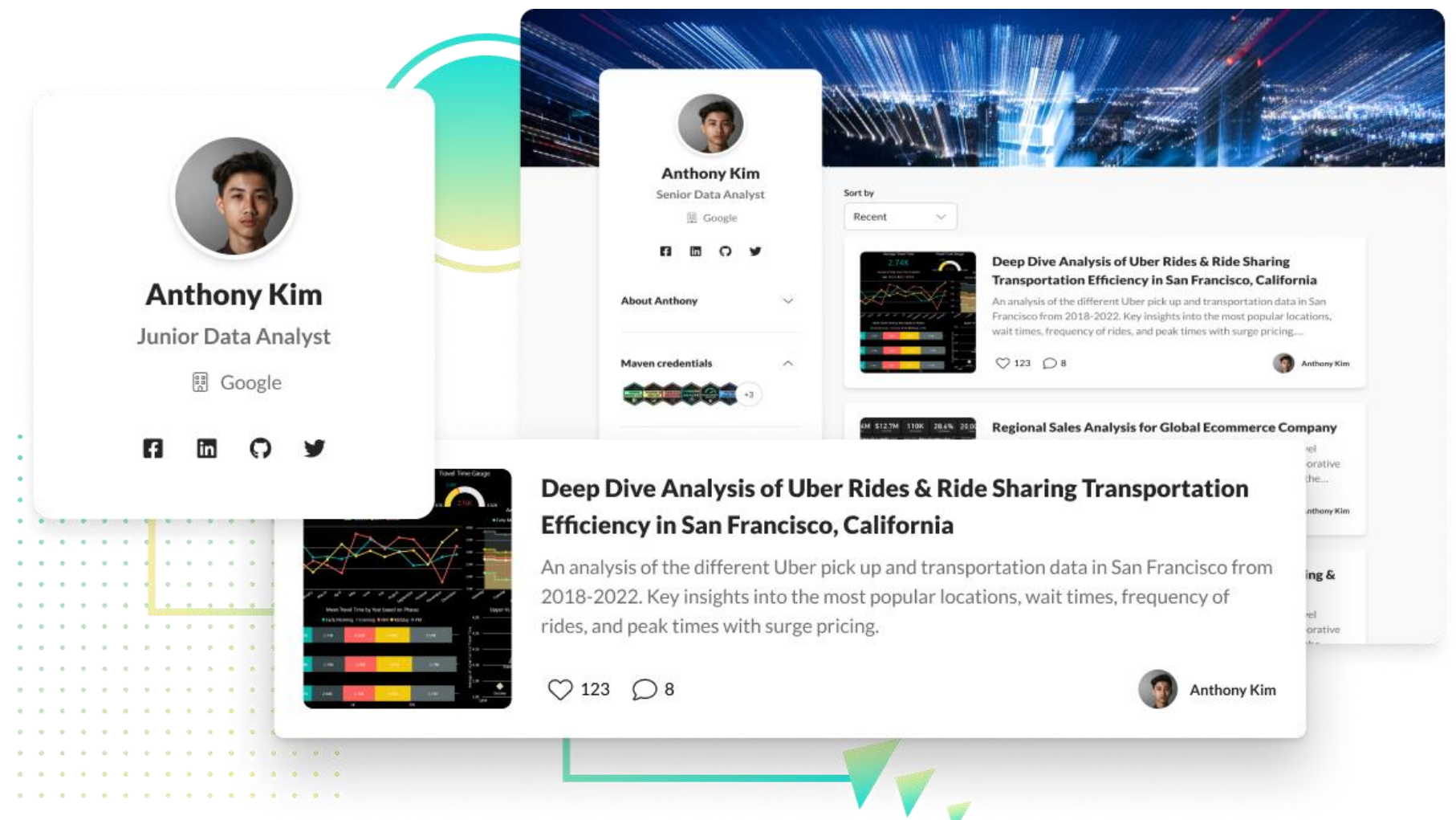
MAVEN ANALYTICS SHOWCASE

A PROJECT PORTFOLIO FOR DATA ANALYSTS

We created a purpose-built platform for data professionals to showcase their work, share projects with peers and employers, and connect with top analytics talent around the world

Why we love the Maven Showcase:

- ✓ Easily shareable
- ✓ Clear & consumable
- ✓ Publicly accessible
- ✓ Easy to build & manage
- ✓ FREE to create & host



OTHER PORTFOLIO SOLUTIONS

Portfolio Option:

LinkedIn

Pros:

- ✓ First place recruiters often look
- ✓ Easy to create and manage (posts + articles)

Cons:

- ✗ Limited customization options

Website/Blog

- ✓ Offers the most customization
- ✓ Best presentation if done well
- ✓ Makes it obvious you are invested

- ✗ More work to set up and manage
- ✗ Can carry some hosting costs
- ✗ May not lead to passive discovery

Tableau Public

- ✓ Easy to share Tableau dashboards
- ✓ High visibility within the Tableau community

- ✗ Only applicable for Tableau-specific projects
- ✗ May not lead to passive discovery

GitHub

- ✓ Common option for technical roles (DS/ML)
- ✓ Good customization options

- ✗ Learning curve to get up and running
- ✗ May not lead to passive discovery

PDF/Slides

- ✓ Free and easy to customize
- ✓ Good format for explanatory analysis

- ✗ Limited sharing options
- ✗ Inaccessible to the public

ASSIGNMENT: BUILD A PORTFOLIO PROJECT

1 Choose a project or analysis you've worked on

- *This can be from real-world experience, a course you worked on, or an online dataset or challenge*

2 Add it as a new project to your portfolio on the Maven Analytics platform

- *Write a clear, concise, and descriptive enough **project title** and **excerpt** to draw viewers in*
- *Upload a **featured image** to provide a single, clear visual representation of your project*

3 Use the project description to outline your thought process and approach

- *What's the **business case** or **context** behind the project?*
- *What **key insights** were you able to derive, and what **impact** did they have on the business?*

4 Provide more detail with the embedded media and additional images

- *Embed a fully functional **Power BI** or **Tableau** dashboard which viewers can interact with directly*
- *Include screenshots or images of code samples, raw data tables, data models, or additional dashboard views or report pages*

KEY TAKEAWAYS



Project portfolios are the best way to **prove your analytics skills**

- *Employers want to see that you have what it takes to get the job done*



Find or **create your own projects** if you don't have job experience

- *Use free online data sources to create your own projects, or seek out real-world volunteer opportunities*



Use the Maven Analytics platform to **build, host, & share** your project portfolio

- *It's free, publicly accessible, and purposefully built for data professionals to showcase their skills*



Make sure your **communication skills & personality** shine through

- *Use your portfolio to showcase strategic thinking & communication skills, not just technical proficiency*



FINDING YOUR PATH



Finding Your Path in Data

Explore common data roles and find your perfect career path

RESUME WRITING



Optimizing Your Resume

Write a winning resume that stands out from the crowd

PERSONAL BRANDING



Building Your Personal Brand

Build a personal brand and market your skills on LinkedIn

PORTFOLIO BUILDING



Building a World-Class Portfolio

Showcase your work with an eye-catching project portfolio

NETWORK BUILDING



Networking & Applying for Jobs

Grow your network and open the door to new opportunities

ACING THE INTERVIEW



Acing the Analyst Interview

Learn proven frameworks to crack the toughest data interviews